

INTEGRATION OF THE PRINCELY STATES & THE MAKING OF THE REPUBLIC

LAPSE OF PARAMOUNTCY AND → COUNTING CONVENTION: WHY MORE → THE STATES DEPARTMENT AS → THREE SUBJECTS TAKEN, EVERYTHING → THE ACCESSION CALENDAR OF → THE PRINCE SQUEEZED FROM

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 LAPSE OF PARAMOUNTCY AND THE CONSTRUCTED UNION

LAPSE OF PARAMOUNTCY AND THE CONSTRUCTED UNION

15 AUG 1947

BRITISH RULE ENDS

PARAMOUNTCY LAPSES (IT IS NOT TRANSFERRED)

BRITISH INDIA

PARTITIONED BY STATUTE; SUCCESSOR DOMINIONS DEFINED IN LAW

PRINCELY INDIA

NO SUCCESSOR SOVEREIGN IN LAW

15 AUG 1947 → BRITISH RULE ENDS → paramountcy LAPSES (it is not transferred)

BRITISH INDIA → partitioned by statute; successor dominions defined in law

PRINCELY INDIA → no successor sovereign in law → authority must be constructed

INSTRUMENTS USED → agreement + leverage + popular pressure + force in one case

RULE → lapse, not transfer; the single word that generates the whole topic.

CORE CLAIM

- 15 AUG 1947 → BRITISH RULE ENDS → paramountcy LAPSES (it is not transferred)
- BRITISH INDIA → partitioned by statute; successor dominions defined in law

MECHANISM

- PRINCELY INDIA → no successor sovereign in law → authority must be constructed
- INSTRUMENTS USED → agreement + leverage + popular pressure + force in one case

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RULE → lapse, not transfer; the single word that generates the whole topic.
- 15 AUG 1947 → BRITISH RULE ENDS → paramountcy LAPSES (it is not transferred)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → lapse, not transfer; the single word that generates the whole topic.

01

STAGE 01 COUNTING CONVENTION: WHY MORE THAN 560 IS THE SAFE FORM

COUNTING CONVENTION

WHY MORE THAN 560 IS THE SAFE FORM

"MORE THAN 560"

REQUIRED FORMULATION IN BOTH REPOSITORY OWNERS

DIFFERENT CLASSIFICATION RULES FOR ESTATES, JAGIRS, MINOR HOLDINGS

"OVER 560"

THE FORM USED ON OFFICIAL COMMEMORATIVE PAGES LOCAL OCR

CORRUPTED IN EXTRACTION; CANNOT ARBITRATE BETWEEN TOTALS

CLAIM

"more than 560"

562 / 565

"over 560"

STATUS

required formulation in both repository owners

different classification rules for estates, jagirs, minor holdings

the form used on official commemorative pages local OCR numeral

CORE CLAIM

- "more than 560"
- required formulation in both repository owners
- 562 / 565

MECHANISM

- different classification rules for estates, jagirs, minor holdings
- "over 560"
- the form used on official commemorative pages local OCR numeral

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- corrupted in extraction; cannot arbitrate between totals
- VERDICT → the disagreement is about enumeration conventions, not about history.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → the disagreement is about enumeration conventions, not about history.

02

STAGE 02 THE STATES DEPARTMENT AS A WORKING MACHINE

THE STATES DEPARTMENT AS A WORKING MACHINE

STATES DEPARTMENT (CREATED 27 JUNE 1947)

SARDAR VALLABHBHAI PATEL, HOME AND STATES MINISTER

V.P. MENON, DRAFTING, NEGOTIATION, ADMINISTRATIVE SEQUENCING

APPEAL TO PATRIOTISM + NARROW LEGAL DEMAND + WARNING

STANDARDISED INSTRUMENTS OF ACCESSION AND STANDSTILL ARRANGEMENTS

NAMING RULE

MINISTER, SECRETARY AND DEPARTMENT TOGETHER, NEVER ONE MAN ALONE.

STATES DEPARTMENT (created 27 June 1947)

MINISTER → Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Home and States Minister

SECRETARY → V.P. Menon, drafting, negotiation, administrative sequencing

METHOD → appeal to patriotism + narrow legal demand + warning of stiffer terms

CORE CLAIM

- STATES DEPARTMENT (created 27 June 1947)
- MINISTER → Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Home and States Minister

MECHANISM

- SECRETARY → V.P. Menon, drafting, negotiation, administrative sequencing
- METHOD → appeal to patriotism + narrow legal demand + warning of stiffer terms

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PRODUCT → standardised Instruments of Accession and standstill arrangements
- NAMING RULE → minister, secretary and department together, never one man alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NAMING RULE → minister, secretary and department together, never one man alone.

03

STAGE 03 THREE SUBJECTS TAKEN, EVERYTHING ELSE LEFT BEHIND

STATES DEPARTMENT (created 27 June 1947)

• MINISTER → Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Home and States Minister

SECRETARY → V.P. Menon, drafting, negotiation, administrative sequencing

• METHOD → appeal to patriotism + narrow legal demand + warning of stiffer terms

PRODUCT → standardised instruments of Accession and Statistat arrangements

• NAMING RULE → minister, secretary and department together, never one man alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NAMING RULE → minister, secretary and department together, never one man alone.

03

STAGE 03

THREE SUBJECTS TAKEN, EVERYTHING ELSE LEFT BEHIND

THREE SUBJECTS TAKEN, EVERYTHING ELSE LEFT BEHIND

TRANSFERRED AT ACCESSION

RETAINED BY THE RULER AT ACCESSION

INTERNAL ADMINISTRATION

EXTERNAL AFFAIRS

REVENUE AND TAXATION INSIDE THE STATE

COURTS AND INTERNAL JUSTICE SUCCESSION, TITLES, CEREMONIAL PRIVILEGE

WHY IT WORKED

TRANSFERRED AT ACCESSION	RETAINED BY THE RULER AT ACCESSION
Defence	internal administration
External Affairs	revenue and taxation inside the state
Communications	courts and internal justice succession, titles, ceremonial privilege

CORE CLAIM

• TRANSFERRED AT ACCESSION

• RETAINED BY THE RULER AT ACCESSION

• internal administration

MECHANISM

• External Affairs

• revenue and taxation inside the state

• courts and internal justice succession, titles, ceremonial privilege

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• WHY IT WORKED → the three taken were exactly the three no state could exercise alone

• WHY IT LOOKED SMALL → the ruler's visible world was untouched on the day of signature.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WHY IT LOOKED SMALL → the ruler's visible world was untouched on the day of signature.

04

STAGE 04

THE ACCESSION CALENDAR OF 1947

THE ACCESSION CALENDAR OF 1947

20 FEB 1947

PARAMOUNTCY WILL NOT BE HANDED TO ANY GOVERNMENT OF

APR 1947

SOME STATES JOIN THE CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY; OTHERS ANNOUNCE INDEPENDENCE

18 JUN 1947

STATES BECOME INDEPENDENT SOVEREIGN STATES ON TERMINATION

27 JUN 1947

20 FEB 1947 → Attlee: paramountcy will not be handed to any government of British

APR 1947 → some states join the Constituent Assembly; others announce independence hopes

18 JUN 1947 → Jinnah: states become independent sovereign states on termination

27 JUN 1947 → States Department created; Patel takes charge, V.P. Menon as Secretary

15 AUG 1947 → all states except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir, Hyderabad have acceded

CORE CLAIM

• 20 FEB 1947 → Attlee: paramountcy will not be handed to any government of British India

• APR 1947 → some states join the Constituent Assembly; others announce independence hopes

MECHANISM

• 18 JUN 1947 → Jinnah: states become independent sovereign states on termination

• 27 JUN 1947 → States Department created; Patel takes charge, V.P. Menon as Secretary

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• 15 AUG 1947 → all states except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir, Hyderabad have acceded

• READ AS → a seven-week campaign against a legal vacuum, not a leisurely negotiation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READ AS → a seven-week campaign against a legal vacuum, not a leisurely negotiation.

05

STAGE 05

THE PRINCE SQUEEZED FROM ABOVE AND BELOW

THE PRINCE SQUEEZED FROM ABOVE AND BELOW

PRESSURE FROM ABOVE

STATES DEPARTMENT

ACCEDE NARROWLY NOW, OR FACE STIFFER TERMS

PRESSURE FROM BELOW

STATES' PEOPLES' CONFERENCE

DEMOCRATIC ORDER AND INTEGRATION

PRESSURE FROM OUTSIDE

PRESSURE FROM ABOVE → States Department: accede narrowly now, or face stiffer terms

PRESSURE FROM BELOW → States' Peoples' Conference: democratic order and integration

PRESSURE FROM OUTSIDE → Partition violence makes isolation dangerous, not sovereign

DOCTRINE AGAINST HIM → political power belongs to the people of a state, not to

BARGAIN OFFERED → three subjects surrendered; dignities, succession and income retained

CORE CLAIM

• PRESSURE FROM ABOVE → States Department: accede narrowly now, or face stiffer terms

• PRESSURE FROM BELOW → States' Peoples' Conference: democratic order and integration

MECHANISM

• PRESSURE FROM OUTSIDE → Partition violence makes isolation dangerous, not sovereign

• DOCTRINE AGAINST HIM → political power belongs to the people of a state, not to the ruler

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• BARGAIN OFFERED → three subjects surrendered; dignities, succession and income retained

• OUTCOME → the overwhelming majority accede without force being used at all.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OUTCOME → the overwhelming majority accede without force being used at all.

06

STAGE 06

FOUR STAGES, FOUR INSTRUMENTS, FOUR DIFFICULTIES

FOUR STAGES, FOUR INSTRUMENTS, FOUR DIFFICULTIES

1 ACCESSION

INSTRUMENT OF ACCESSION, THREE SUBJECTS

BY 15 AUG 1947

2 MERGER

MERGER AGREEMENTS, UNIONS, ATTACHMENTS

FROM DEC 1947

3 DEMOCRATISATION

1 ACCESSION → Instrument of Accession, three subjects → by 15 Aug 1947

2 MERGER → merger agreements, unions, attachments → from Dec 1947

3 DEMOCRATISATION → elections, courts, services inside old states → uneven and slower

4 INCORPORATION → Constitution and single citizenship → 26 Jan 1950

STRUCTURAL ERROR → treating stage one as the finished process

CORE CLAIM

MECHANISM

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

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06

STAGE 06 FOUR STAGES, FOUR INSTRUMENTS, FOUR DIFFICULTIES

FOUR STAGES, FOUR INSTRUMENTS, FOUR DIFFICULTIES

1 ACCESSION

INSTRUMENT OF ACCESSION, THREE SUBJECTS

BY 15 AUG 1947

2 MERGER

MERGER AGREEMENTS, UNIONS, ATTACHMENTS

FROM DEC 1947

3 DEMOCRATISATION

1 ACCESSION → Instrument of Accession, three subjects → by 15 Aug 1947

2 MERGER → merger agreements, unions, attachments → from Dec 1947

3 DEMOCRATISATION → elections, courts, services inside old states → uneven and slower

4 INCORPORATION → Constitution and single citizenship → 26 Jan 1950

STRUCTURAL ERROR → treating stage one as the finished process

CORE CLAIM

- 1 ACCESSION → Instrument of Accession, three subjects → by 15 Aug 1947
- 2 MERGER → merger agreements, unions, attachments → from Dec 1947

MECHANISM

- 3 DEMOCRATISATION → elections, courts, services inside old states → uneven and slower
- 4 INCORPORATION → Constitution and single citizenship → 26 Jan 1950

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STRUCTURAL ERROR → treating stage one as the finished process
- CORRECTION → each stage has its own instrument, its own date and its own difficulty.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CORRECTION → each stage has its own instrument, its own date and its own difficulty.

07

STAGE 07 JUNAGADH SETTLED BY COUNTING PEOPLE

JUNAGADH SETTLED BY COUNTING PEOPLE

NAWAB ACCEDES TO PAKISTAN

AGAINST POPULATION AND AGAINST GEOGRAPHY

POPULATION OVERWHELMINGLY HINDU

POPULAR MOVEMENT

NAWAB FLEES

PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT FORMED INSIDE THE STATE

DEWAN SHAH NAWAZ BHUTTO INVITES THE GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

NAWAB accedes to Pakistan → against population and against geography

POPULATION overwhelmingly Hindu → popular movement → Nawab flees

PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT formed inside the state

DEWAN Shah Nawaz Bhutto invites the Government of India to intervene

INDIAN TROOPS enter; PLEBISCITE held FEBRUARY 1948 → result favours India

CORE CLAIM

- NAWAB accedes to Pakistan → against population and against geography
- POPULATION overwhelmingly Hindu → popular movement → Nawab flees

MECHANISM

- PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT formed inside the state
- DEWAN Shah Nawaz Bhutto invites the Government of India to intervene

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- INDIAN TROOPS enter; PLEBISCITE held FEBRUARY 1948 → result favours India
- DISCIPLINE → the source calls the result overwhelming; no percentage is asserted here.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISCIPLINE → the source calls the result overwhelming; no percentage is asserted here.

08

STAGE 08 HYDERABAD: NEGOTIATION EXHAUSTED BEFORE FORCE

NEGOTIATION EXHAUSTED BEFORE FORCE

PRE-AUG 1947

NIZAM CLAIMS INDEPENDENT STATUS; STATE LANDLOCKED INSIDE INDIA

NOV 1947

STANDSTILL AGREEMENT SIGNED; REPRESENTATIVE GOVERNMENT HOPED FOR

ITTIHAD UL MUSLIMIN AND RAZAKARS GROW; STATE CONGRESS SATYAGRAHA

COMMUNIST-LED PEASANT STRUGGLE CONTINUES IN THE TELANGANA REGION

JUN 1948

PRE-AUG 1947 → Nizam claims independent status; state landlocked inside India

NOV 1947 → STANDSTILL AGREEMENT signed; representative government hoped for

1947-48 → Ittihad ul Muslimin and Razakars grow; State Congress satyagraha

Communist-led peasant struggle continues in the Telangana region

JUN 1948 → Patel presses for unqualified accession and responsible government

CORE CLAIM

- PRE-AUG 1947 → Nizam claims independent status; state landlocked inside India
- NOV 1947 → STANDSTILL AGREEMENT signed; representative government hoped for
- 1947-48 → Ittihad ul Muslimin and Razakars grow; State Congress satyagraha

MECHANISM

- Communist-led peasant struggle continues in the Telangana region
- JUN 1948 → Patel presses for unqualified accession and responsible government
- SEP 1948 → OPERATION POLO / POLICE ACTION → Nizam surrenders → accedes to the Union

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DISCIPLINE → no casualty figure and no troop figure is asserted for this episode.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISCIPLINE → no casualty figure and no troop figure is asserted for this episode.

09

STAGE 09 KASHMIR: THE FIXED ORDER OF EVENTS

THE FIXED ORDER OF EVENTS

STEP 1

MAHARAJA HARI SINGH ACCEDES TO NEITHER DOMINION

STEP 2

NATIONAL CONFERENCE UNDER SHEIKH ABDULLAH FAVOURS ACCESSION TO INDIA

STEP 3

OCTOBER 1947 TRIBAL INVASION ADVANCES TOWARDS SRINAGAR

STEP 4

STEP 1 → Maharaja Hari Singh accedes to neither dominion

STEP 2 → National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah favours accession to India

STEP 3 → OCTOBER 1947 tribal invasion advances towards Srinagar

STEP 4 → Maharaja appeals to India for military assistance

STEP 5 → Instrument of Accession signed; Sheikh Abdullah heads the administration

CORE CLAIM

- STEP 1 → Maharaja Hari Singh accedes to neither dominion
- STEP 2 → National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah favours accession to India
- STEP 3 → OCTOBER 1947 tribal invasion advances towards Srinagar

MECHANISM

- STEP 4 → Maharaja appeals to India for military assistance
- STEP 5 → Instrument of Accession signed; Sheikh Abdullah heads the administration
- STEP 6 → troops flown to Srinagar only AFTER accession

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STEP 7 → 30 DEC 1947 reference to the UN Security Council; fighting continues
- STOP LINE → restraint beyond step seven; contested later claims are not taught here.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STOP LINE → restraint beyond step seven; contested later claims are not taught here.

CORE CLAIM

- STEP 1 → Maharaja Hari Singh accedes to neither dominion
- STEP 2 → National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah favours accession to India
- STEP 3 → OCTOBER 1947 tribal invasion advances towards Srinagar

MECHANISM

- STEP 4 → Maharaja appeals to India for military assistance
- STEP 5 → Instrument of Accession signed; Sheikh Abdullah heads the administration
- STEP 6 → troops flown to Srinagar only AFTER accession

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STEP 7 → 30 DEC 1947 reference to the UN Security Council; fighting continues
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STOP LINE → restraint beyond step seven; contested later claims are not taught here.

10

STAGE 10

THE MERGER MAP OF THE SECOND STAGE

THE MERGER MAP OF THE SECOND STAGE

SECOND STAGE (FROM DECEMBER 1947)

TURNING ACCEDING UNITS INTO GOVERNABLE PROVINCES

SMALL STATES ATTACHED TO NEIGHBOURING PROVINCES OR CENTRALLY ADMINISTERED

MADHYA BHARAT

PATIALA AND EAST PUNJAB STATES UNION

→ SAURASHTRA

JAMMU AND KASHMIR AS SEPARATE STATES OF THE UNION

MERGED → small states attached to neighbouring provinces or centrally administered

→

UNIONS → Madhya Bharat

→

Patiala and East Punjab States Union

CORE CLAIM

- SECOND STAGE (from December 1947) → turning acceding units into governable provinces
- MERGED → small states attached to neighbouring provinces or centrally administered
- UNIONS → Madhya Bharat

MECHANISM

- Patiala and East Punjab States Union
- Saurashtra
- RETAINED → Mysore

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Jammu and Kashmir as separate states of the Union
- RESULT → a deliberately asymmetrical map that later reorganisation would revisit.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → a deliberately asymmetrical map that later reorganisation would revisit.

11

STAGE 11

PRICE PAID, PROCESS COMPLETED, COMMEMORATION HANDLED

PRICE PAID, PROCESS COMPLETED, COMMEMORATION HANDLED

PRIVY PURSES, TITLES, SUCCESSION, CEREMONIAL PRIVILEGE RETAINED BY RULERS

NOT ABOLISHED DURING INITIAL INTEGRATION; OWNER DATES ABOLITION TO

NO PURSE AMOUNT IS ASSERTED ANYWHERE IN THIS PACKAGE

COMPLETION→ CONSTITUTION ADOPTED 26 NOV 1949; IN FORCE 26

INDEPENDENCE 15 AUG 1947 AND REPUBLIC 26 JAN 1950

MINISTRY OF CULTURE TWO-YEAR PROGRAMME FROM 31 OCT 2024

PIB BACKGROUNDER 30 OCT 2025

PRICE → privy purses, titles, succession, ceremonial privilege retained by rulers

→

not abolished during initial integration; owner dates abolition to 1971

→

no purse amount is asserted anywhere in this package

→

COMPLETION→ Constitution adopted 26 Nov 1949; in force 26 Jan 1950; single citizenship

→

independence 15 Aug 1947 and republic 26 Jan 1950 answer different questions

CORE CLAIM

- PRICE → privy purses, titles, succession, ceremonial privilege retained by rulers
- not abolished during initial integration; owner dates abolition to 1971
- no purse amount is asserted anywhere in this package

MECHANISM

- COMPLETION→ Constitution adopted 26 Nov 1949; in force 26 Jan 1950; single citizenship
- independence 15 Aug 1947 and republic 26 Jan 1950 answer different questions
- COMMEMORATION → Ministry of Culture two-year programme from 31 Oct 2024 at the Statue of Unity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PIB Backgrounder 30 Oct 2025: Rashtriya Ekta Diwas annually on 31 October
- CAUTION → the commemorative phrase "by 15 August 1947 or shortly thereafter" compresses a chronology that runs to February and September 1948.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → the commemorative phrase "by 15 August 1947 or shortly thereafter" compresses a chronology that runs to February and September 1948.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT ENDED BRITISH PARAMOUNTCY, CREATING A

PRINCELY RULERS COULD NOT SIMPLY BE ASSUMED TO BE

PATEL AND V.P. MENON COMBINED PERSUASION, CONCESSIONS, PRESSURE AND

THE INSTRUMENT OF ACCESSION WAS DELIBERATELY LIMITED TO DEFENCE

AND COMMUNICATIONS TO MAKE ACCESSION POLITICALLY ACCEPTABLE AND ADMINISTRATIVELY

CHANDRA DISTINGUISHES TWO STAGES

ACCESSION ON THE THREE COMMON SUBJECTS, THEN MERGER, DEMOCRATISATION

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- The Indian Independence Act ended British paramountcy, creating a legal vacuum in which
- princely rulers could not simply be assumed to be part of India.
- Patel and V.P. Menon combined persuasion, concessions, pressure and the leverage created by peoples' movements in the states.
- The Instrument of Accession was deliberately limited to Defence, External Affairs

ADVANCED DEBATE

- and Communications to make accession politically acceptable and administratively quick.
- Chandra distinguishes two stages: accession on the three common subjects, then merger, democratisation and constitutional integration.
- CAUTION: Junagadh demonstrated the use of popular will and geography against a ruler's accession to Pakistan.
- CAUTION: Hyderabad demonstrated the limits of negotiation when an inland state sought independence and Razakar mobilisation threatened order.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- CAUTION: Kashmir demonstrated the security dimension of accession, linking legal accession to war, UN involvement and later constitutional debate.
- CAUTION: The making of the Republic transformed accession into a constitutional
- Union, but debates over autonomy, federalism and special provisions continued.
- CAUTION: Patel was Home and States Minister; V.P. Menon was central to the States Department's negotiations.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.